

RETAILNEXT X OPENAI

OPENAI-POWERED EVENT SHOPPING ASSISTANT FOR RETAILNEXT.

A natural language assistant that helps shoppers describe what they need, checks real inventory, and carries the journey into web, app, WhatsApp, associate, and email follow-up channels.

CHAT-FIRST

customers ask in natural language or share a photo

REALITY CHECKED

inventory, size, price and fulfilment checked before display

REUSABLE PATTERN

one assistant can reach web, app, WhatsApp, store and email follow-up

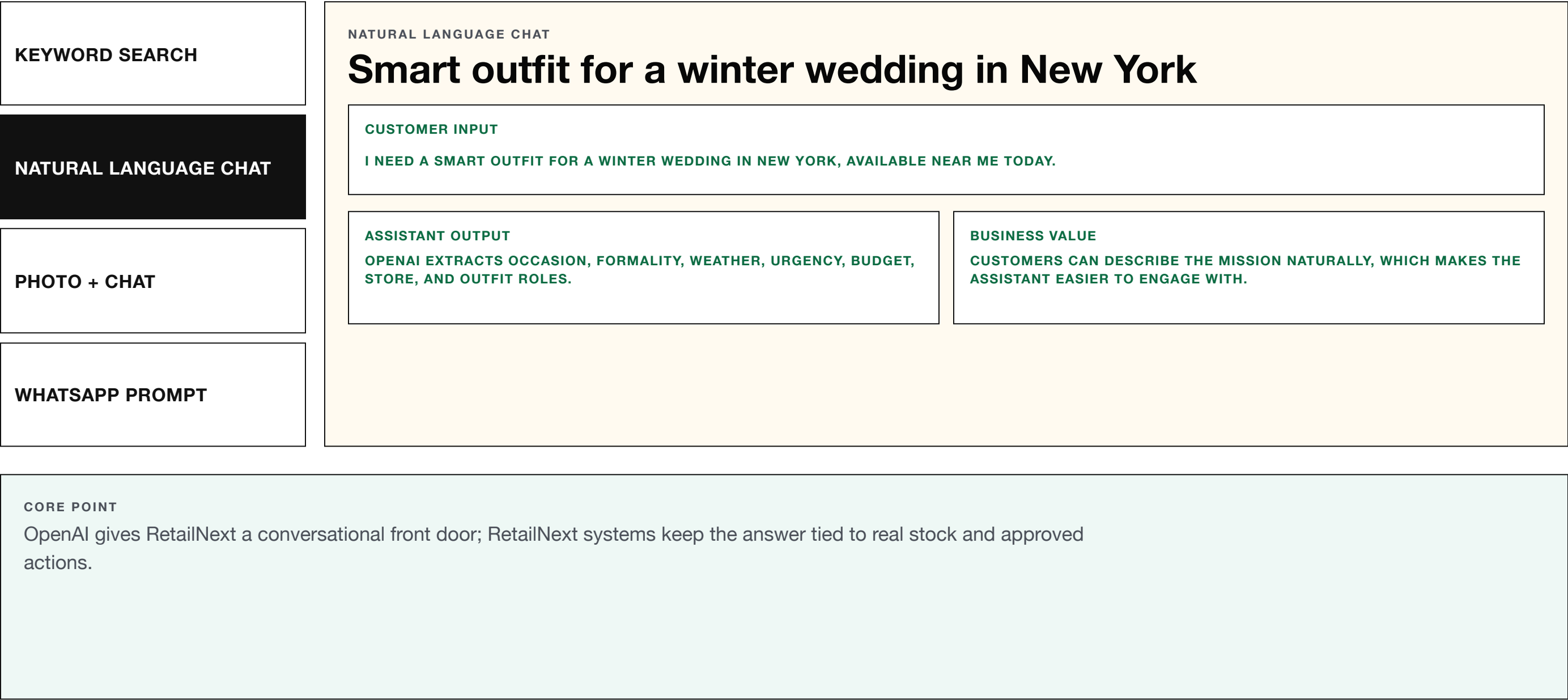
EVENT SHOPPERS STRUGGLE TO FIND OR CONFIRM THE RIGHT ITEMS QUICKLY.

Reviews point to the same issue: discovery, availability, and store confidence are split across the journey.

CUSTOMER Occasion-led demand "I need something for a winter wedding" is a better brief than "black dress".	STORE Availability uncertainty Customers and associates still need to confirm store, size, substitutes, and timing.	BUSINESS High-intent friction Event shoppers have urgency, higher basket potential, and lower tolerance for failed searches.
LOST CONVERSION high-intent shoppers abandon when availability confidence is low	MANUAL LOOKUP associates bridge style, stock, substitutes, and customer messaging	BRAND TRUST poor reviews compound when store discovery falls short of the digital promise

THE INTERFACE MATTERS: CHAT CAPTURES MORE OF THE BUYING MISSION.

Customers are more likely to engage when they can explain the occasion in their own words.



AN INVENTORY-GROUNDED AI ASSISTANT FOR EVENT SHOPPING.

OpenAI interprets text, images and follow-up chat. RetailNext verifies stock, price and fulfilment before a recommendation is shown.

UNDERSTAND Text, image, occasion, style, budget, store	RETRIEVE Semantic catalogue matches	GROUND Inventory API checks SKU, size, price and fulfilment	CONVERSE Swap, explain, refine, email	ACTIVATE Basket, associate handoff, engagement follow-up
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OPENAI ROLE

Understand and converse

Intent extraction, image understanding, semantic retrieval inputs, tool choice, explanations and review.

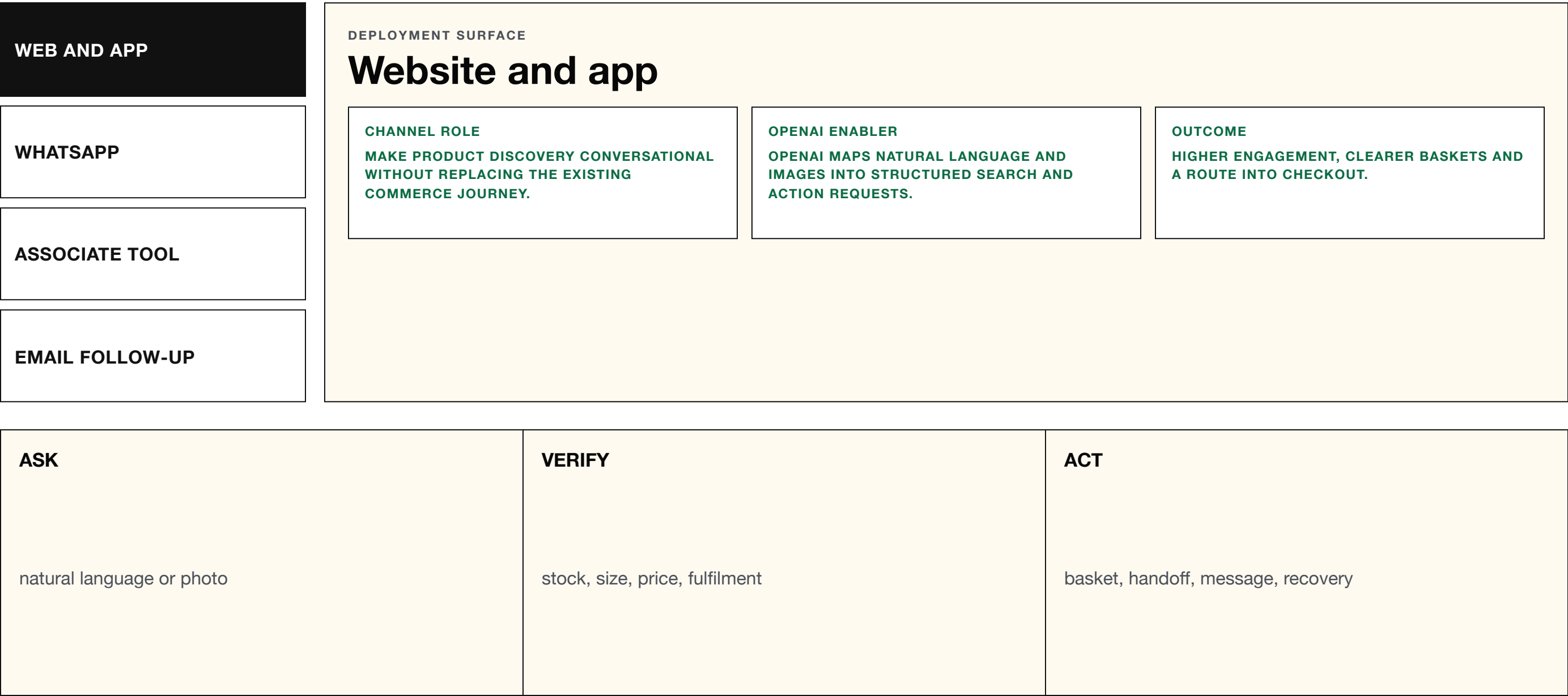
RETAILNEXT ROLE

Control retail decisions

Catalogue, inventory, price, basket state, store rules, fulfilment and engagement-platform actions.

THE AGENT CAN USE APPROVED TOOLS WHEREVER CUSTOMERS ALREADY SHOP.

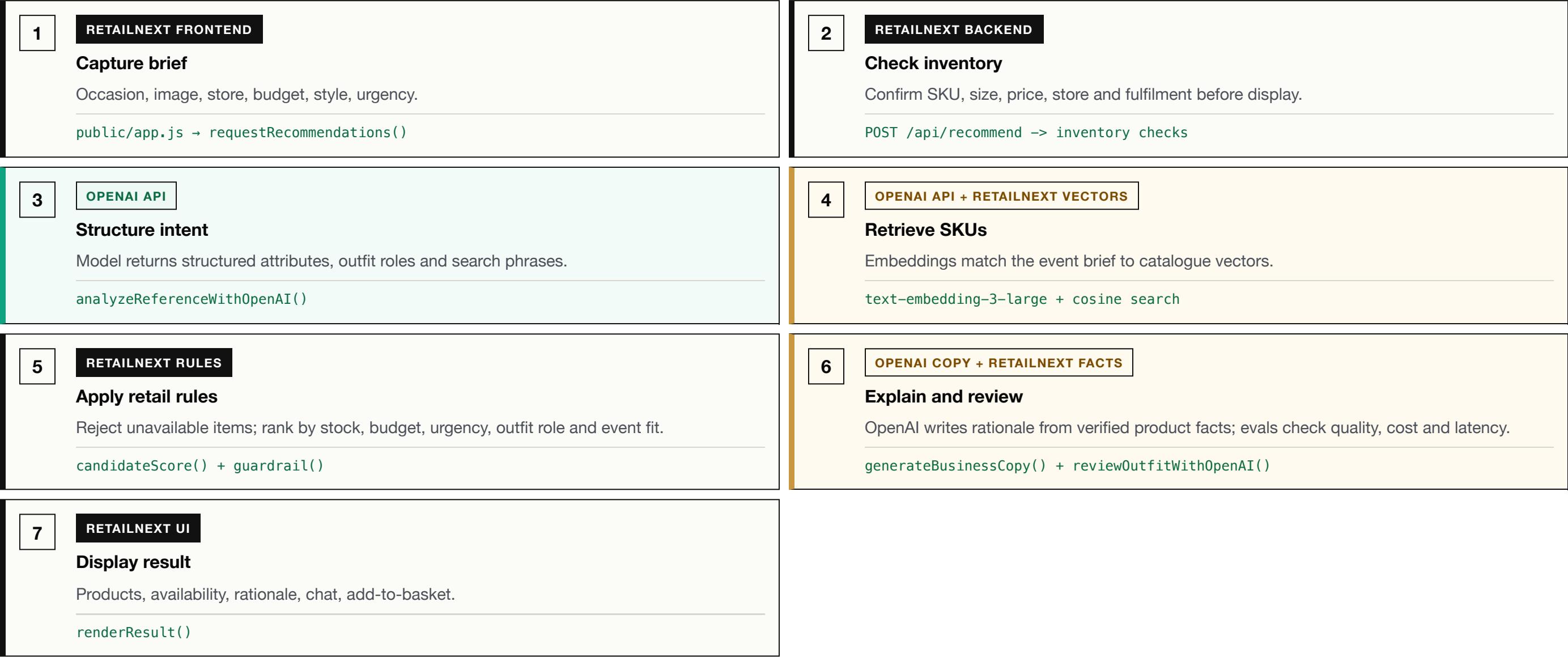
In this demo the tools are API calls; in production they could be existing services or MCP servers for inventory, basket and engagement.



GENERATE OUTFIT: SUGGEST, VERIFY, DISPLAY.

LLMs are non-deterministic, so the app treats model output as a proposal and uses RetailNext APIs as the hard checks.

- RETAILNEXT OWNED
- OPENAI API
- OPENAI + RETAILNEXT



IMPORTANT BOUNDARY

The model can propose, but RetailNext APIs decide. Every shown product has passed SKU, stock, size, price and fulfilment checks.

FLEXIBLE AGENT, CONTROLLED ACTIONS.

The agent can call only approved tools: retrieval, inventory, basket, engagement and review.



RETAILNEXT FRONTEND

Mission capture

A shopper starts from chat, product, or image, then adds occasion, store, budget, and urgency.

The assistant captures a richer brief than a keyword box.

OPENAI API POWERED

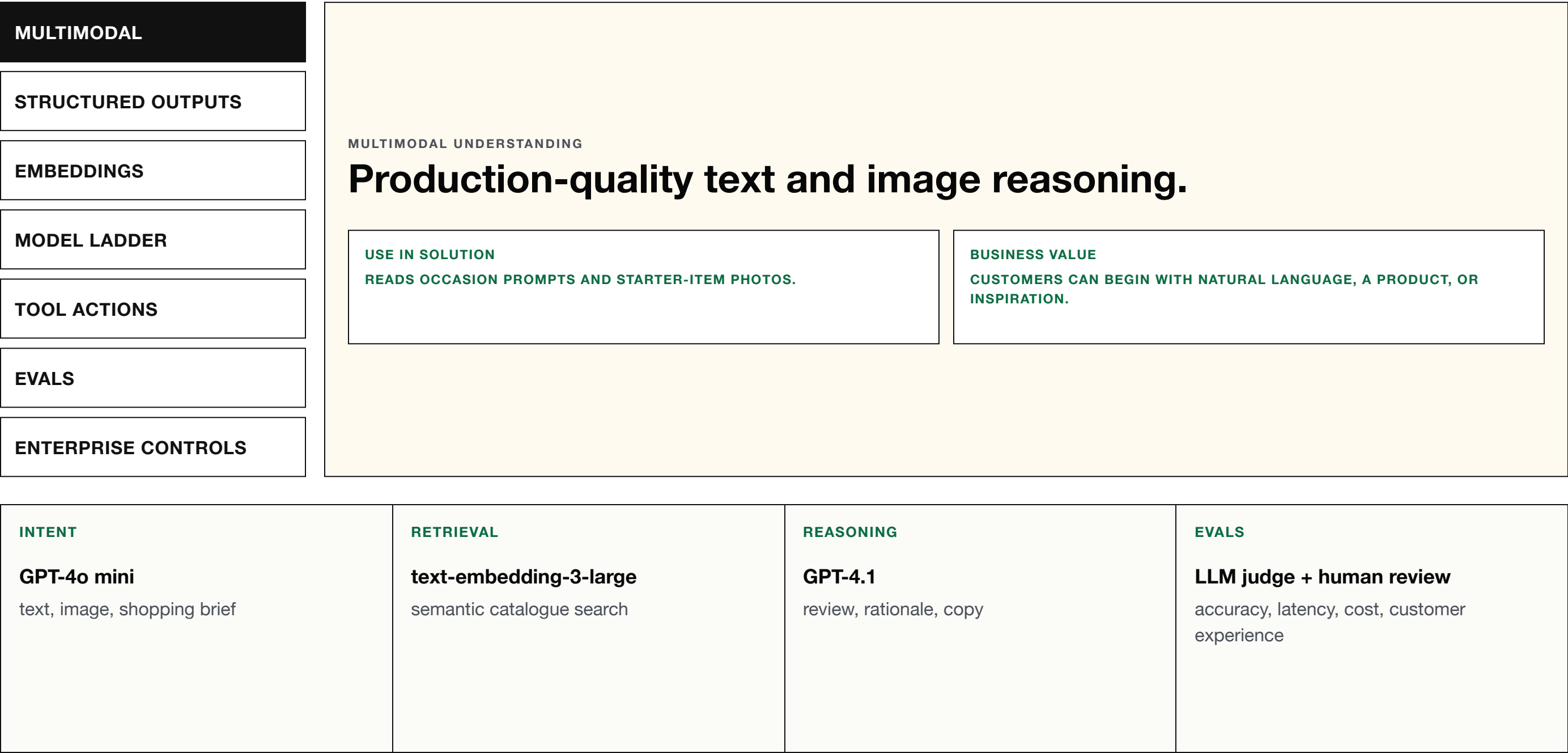
- Text and image understanding
- Structured JSON shopping briefs
- Embeddings for semantic retrieval
- Tool selection and structured action requests
- Grounded copy and evals for quality, latency and cost

RETAILNEXT OWNED

- Approved APIs or MCP servers for inventory, basket and engagement
- Catalogue, product images, prices, stores and inventory
- Budget, availability, substitutes, and fulfilment rules
- Preview/apply safety for basket changes
- Pilot design, ROI targets, channel deployment and email handoff

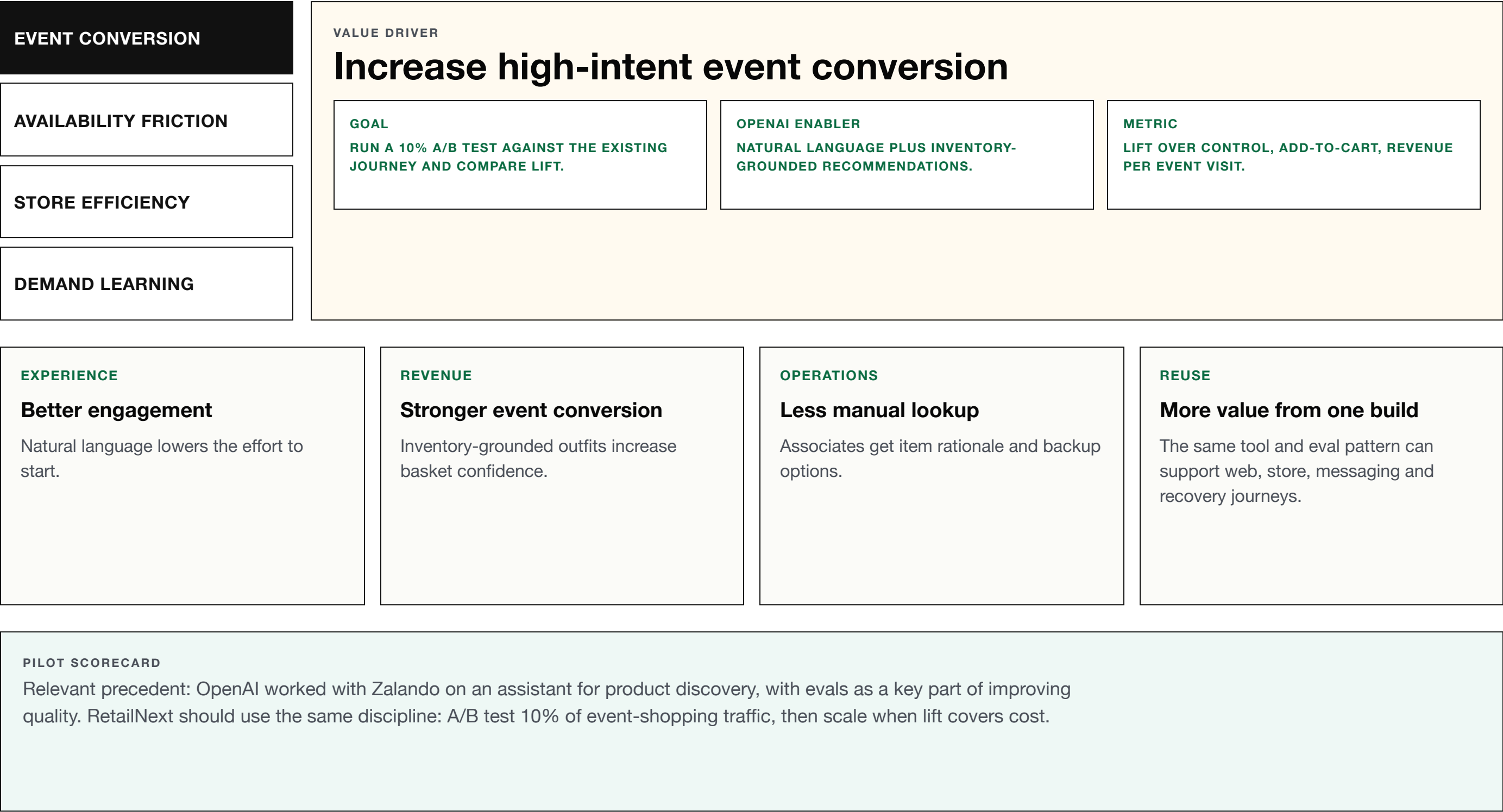
OPENAI IS THE PLATFORM LAYER FOR A REUSABLE ASSISTANT PATTERN.

Multimodal understanding, structured outputs, embeddings, tool calling and evals form a pattern RetailNext can reuse beyond this one journey.



BUSINESS VALUE MAP FOR RETAILNEXT.

The target is measurable ROI, not a novelty chat surface.



CRAWL, WALK, RUN.

Prove the ROI first, then expand the same assistant pattern across the wider commerce journey.

0-8 WEEKS

Crawl

10% web A/B test, selected stores, text assistant, inventory snapshot and baseline scorecard.

2-4 MONTHS

Walk

Photo input, live inventory APIs, engagement-platform actions and eval tuning.

SCALE

Run

Scale across ecommerce, associate tools, WhatsApp and email once ROI is clear.

CLOSING LINE

"Start small, ground every answer in inventory, prove ROI against the control, then reuse the assistant pattern across channels."